

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 45)

Page 222 - Tennyson's Themes and Conservatism

Q1. In which poem did Tennyson grapple with the question of the higher education of women?

- A. Maud
- B. The Princess
- C. Enoch Arden
- D. The May Queen

Answer: B

Q2. 'Maud' quivers with the patriotic passion associated with which war?

- A. The Napoleonic Wars
- B. The Crimean War
- C. The Boer War
- D. The American Civil War

Answer: B

Q3. In the 'Idylls of the King', what did Tennyson do with the old medieval story?

- A. He translated it directly into Latin
- B. He turned it into a parable bearing upon contemporary life
- C. He converted it into a comedy
- D. He replaced all the characters with Greek gods

Answer: B

Q4. Politically and socially, Tennyson stands out as the poetic exponent of the cautious spirit of:

- A. Revolutionary radicalism
- B. Victorian liberalism
- C. Jacobite conservatism
- D. Anarchism

Answer: B

Q5. Tennyson held tenaciously to the great heritage of English tradition and was firmly opposed to:

- A. Law and order
- B. The progress of mankind
- C. 'Raw haste' and rash experiments
- D. The monarchy

Answer: C

Q6. Which famous line is from Tennyson's poetry about change?

- A. 'A thing of beauty is a joy forever'
- B. 'The old order changeth, yielding place to new'
- C. 'Water, water, everywhere'
- D. 'To be, or not to be'

Answer: B

Q7. In the poem cited, why does God fulfill himself in many ways?

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- A. To confuse mankind
- B. Lest one good custom should corrupt the world
- C. To punish the wicked
- D. To show his absolute power

Answer: B

Q8. Despite being a recluse and an aristocrat, Tennyson was profoundly interested in:

- A. Royal genealogy
- B. Common people and common things
- C. Collecting rare medieval manuscripts
- D. Traveling to foreign countries

Answer: B

Q9. Which of the following poems by Tennyson is NOT mentioned as dealing with common people and things?

- A. The May Queen
- B. Enoch Arden
- C. Dora
- D. The Ancient Sage

Answer: D

Q10. Tennyson's thought regarding social and political questions reveals his curious sensitiveness to the tendencies of:

- A. The 18th century
- B. His time (the Victorian era)
- C. Ancient Rome
- D. The Elizabethan age

Answer: B

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Page 223 - Tennyson's Thought and Browning

Q1. Tennyson's poetry is particularly important as a record of what life of the time?

- A. Economic life
- B. Intellectual and spiritual life
- C. Military life
- D. Agricultural life

Answer: B

Q2. In which poem may we best read of the Victorian century's great conflict of doubt and faith?

- A. The Ancient Sage
- B. In Memoriam
- C. Enoch Arden
- D. Maud

Answer: B

Q3. How did Tennyson's view of nature differ from Wordsworth's?

- A. He saw it with the eye of a scientist as well as a poet
- B. He ignored its beauty entirely
- C. He thought it was merely an illusion
- D. He found no minute details to describe

Answer: A

Q4. What aspect of nature disturbed Tennyson's thought?

- A. Its lack of color
- B. Its indifference and cruelty in the cosmic struggle
- C. Its excessive harmony
- D. Its artificiality

Answer: B

Q5. Tennyson's persistent belief in evolution helped him look forward to:

- A. The destruction of the earth
- B. The return of the Middle Ages
- C. The 'one far-off divine event to which the whole creation moves'
- D. The victory of pure materialism

Answer: C

Q6. Robert Browning was born in what year?

- A. 1809
- B. 1812
- C. 1832
- D. 1850

Answer: B

Q7. What was the title of Browning's first published work in 1833?

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- A. Paracelsus
- B. Pauline
- C. Strafford
- D. Sordello

Answer: B

Q8. In 1837, which tragedy by Browning was produced at Covent Garden by Macready?

- A. The Cenci
- B. Remorse
- C. Strafford
- D. Othello

Answer: C

Q9. In 1846, Robert Browning married which poet?

- A. Mary Shelley
- B. Elizabeth Barrett
- C. Christina Rossetti
- D. Felicia Hemans

Answer: B

Q10. Where did Robert and Elizabeth Barrett Browning spend the fifteen happy years of their married life?

- A. France
- B. Scotland
- C. Italy
- D. Germany

Answer: C

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Page 224 - Browning's Major Works and Method

Q1. Which enormous dramatic-narrative poem in four volumes did Browning publish in 1868-69?

- A. The Ring and the Book
- B. Dramatis Personae
- C. Men and Women
- D. Asolando

Answer: A

Q2. What was the title of Browning's last volume, published on the very day he died in 1889?

- A. Paracelsus
- B. The Ring and the Book
- C. Asolando
- D. Bells and Pomegranates

Answer: C

Q3. How is Browning's style contrasted with Tennyson's?

- A. Browning was much more smooth and polished
- B. Browning was bold, rugged, and altogether unconventional
- C. Browning used strict classical meter exclusively
- D. Browning never used dramatic forms

Answer: B

Q4. A common criticism of Browning's later work is that it is:

- A. Too simplistic and childish
- B. Prolix, ill-digested, and marred by harshness and obscurity
- C. An exact imitation of Shakespeare
- D. Completely lacking in any philosophical meaning

Answer: B

Q5. Browning's genius was essentially:

- A. Lyrical
- B. Dramatic
- C. Epic
- D. Satirical

Answer: B

Q6. Rather than the world of action, where was Browning's interest centered?

- A. In the natural landscape
- B. In the moral and spiritual forces and conflicts of individual men and women
- C. In abstract mathematical theories
- D. In political economy

Answer: B

Q7. What was Browning's characteristic art-form, which he used more effectively than any other poet?

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- A. The regular stage-play
- B. The detached speech, or dramatic monologue
- C. The Spenserian stanza
- D. The Petrarchan sonnet

Answer: B

Q8. In his dramatic monologues, how does Browning typically reveal a character?

- A. By dissecting him from the outside as an ordinary novelist would
- B. By making him reveal his innermost secrets through his own utterances, usually at a critical moment
- C. By having a chorus explain his actions
- D. By strictly describing only his physical appearance

Answer: B

Q9. Which two qualities are noted as main features of Browning's poetry?

- A. Perfect rhyme and pastoral settings
- B. Psychological insight and analytical subtlety
- C. Scientific realism and cold logic
- D. Melancholy and despair

Answer: B

Q10. Where did Robert Browning die?

- A. London
- B. Paris
- C. The Palazzo Rezzonico in Venice
- D. Rome

Answer: C

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Page 225 - Browning's Message and Matthew Arnold

Q1. As a moralist and religious teacher, what did Browning preach as the central truths of his philosophy of life?

- A. God and immortality
- B. Scientific materialism and evolution
- C. Agnosticism and doubt
- D. Social revolution

Answer: A

Q2. Browning's poetry was a protest against scientific materialism and also against:

- A. The use of dramatic monologues
- B. The optimistic faith of the age
- C. The pessimistic mood engendered by current philosophy
- D. The teaching of the church

Answer: C

Q3. The melancholy, hesitating spirit so often expressed by Tennyson is:

- A. Imitated perfectly by Browning
- B. Absent from Browning's verse, who retained a robustly optimistic faith
- C. The exact theme of 'The Ring and the Book'
- D. What makes Browning a classicist

Answer: B

Q4. 'Hope hard in the subtle thing that's spirit,' was the note of whose message?

- A. Tennyson
- B. Matthew Arnold
- C. Browning
- D. Arthur Hugh Clough

Answer: C

Q5. Which of Browning's characters says: 'God's in His heaven - all's right with the world'?

- A. Sordello
- B. Pippa
- C. Paracelsus
- D. Strafford

Answer: B

Q6. Who is suggested as holding the third place among poets of the Victorian Age, after Tennyson and Browning?

- A. Matthew Arnold
- B. Arthur Hugh Clough
- C. Dante Gabriel Rossetti
- D. Swinburne

Answer: A

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Q7. By sympathy and training, Matthew Arnold was a thorough:

- A. Romantic
- B. Classicist
- C. Realist
- D. Pre-Raphaelite

Answer: B

Q8. Matthew Arnold believed that all really great poetry is:

- A. Subjective poetry of self-expression
- B. Impersonal or objective poetry (like drama and epic)
- C. Satirical poetry
- D. Lyrical poetry

Answer: B

Q9. Which of the following is one of Matthew Arnold's ambitious objective poems?

- A. Sohrab and Rustum
- B. Maud
- C. The Ring and the Book
- D. Men and Women

Answer: A

Q10. Despite his theory, the true bias of Arnold's genius was towards:

- A. Epic poetry
- B. The poetry of self-expression (personal poetry)
- C. Light comedy
- D. Political pamphlets

Answer: B

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Page 226 - Arnold, Clough, and E.B. Browning

Q1. Most of Matthew Arnold's personal poetry is steeped in:

- A. The robust optimism of Browning
- B. The melancholy spirit of an era of transition
- C. A joyful celebration of nature
- D. Fierce political satire

Answer: B

Q2. The lines 'Wandering between two worlds, one dead, / The other powerless to be born' are from which of Arnold's poems?

- A. Empedocles on Etna
- B. Stanzas from the Grande Chartreuse
- C. Thyrsis
- D. Balder Dead

Answer: B

Q3. How is Arnold's poetic style described?

- A. Cold and clear, with fine restraint and sculptural purity
- B. Lush, ornate, and highly musical
- C. Bold, rugged, and unconventional
- D. Spasmodic and overly emotional

Answer: A

Q4. 'Thyrsis' is Matthew Arnold's noble monody on the death of which friend and spiritual kinsman?

- A. Arthur Henry Hallam
- B. Arthur Hugh Clough
- C. Robert Browning
- D. Lord Tennyson

Answer: B

Q5. Which delightful longer poem by Arthur Hugh Clough deserves to be better known?

- A. The Bothie of Tober-na-Vuolich
- B. Casa Guidi Windows
- C. Aurora Leigh
- D. Sordello

Answer: A

Q6. Who holds the position as the most considerable and vigorous of all women-writers of verse of this period?

- A. Christina Rossetti
- B. Emily Bronte
- C. Elizabeth Barrett Browning
- D. Jane Austen

Answer: C

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Q7. What was one of Elizabeth Barrett Browning's main faults as a writer?

- A. She wrote too little and too slowly
- B. She lacked the faculty of self-criticism and frequently exhibited over-wrought emotionalism
- C. She adhered too strictly to classical rules
- D. Her poetry was completely devoid of emotion

Answer: B

Q8. Elizabeth Barrett Browning's poetry sometimes degenerates into:

- A. Dry philosophical debate
- B. Downright gush and hysterics
- C. Complex mathematical formulas
- D. Purely objective epics

Answer: B

Q9. At her best, what redeeming qualities does Elizabeth Barrett Browning exhibit?

- A. Noble sincerity, genuine passion, and undeniable power over language
- B. Cold clarity and sculptural purity
- C. Subtle psychological analysis and dramatic monologue mastery
- D. A complete detachment from human suffering

Answer: A

Q10. 'Casa Guidi Windows' is a romantic poem by which author?

- A. Robert Browning
- B. Elizabeth Barrett Browning
- C. Matthew Arnold
- D. Arthur Hugh Clough

Answer: B